complaints have been raised about land confiscated by the government past and present, and many of these complaints remain unresolved, the decision to grant such land use concessions for an extended period of time may come under question in some areas. Separate laws have been passed on land use, farmland, and environmental protection (Food Security Working Group 2012),[19] although in reality these reforms have done little to prompt major changes in the regulation of agriculture in Myanmar.

In addition to foreign investment, a new Central Bank law has been introduced.[20] This law granted formal independence for the Central Bank from the Ministry of Finance, reformed the position of the governor of the Central Bank and its board, and restricted the printing of money. The reality, however, is that independence remains something of an illusion. The future operation of banks, including foreign banks, remains limited by the existing Financial Institutions of Myanmar Law. There are multiple tensions in such new areas of regulation — tensions between local and foreign banks; tensions between existing owners of local banks and more recently established local banks; and the general distrust the public has for banks, given their past record in Myanmar.

A further major area of economic reform has been legislation passed to regulate the establishment of Special Economic Zones, marked out for Dawei, Thilawa, Kyauk Pyu, and Kokang areas.[21] The concept itself is not new in Myanmar (Lubeigt 2008; Turnell 2014, p. 194). While the original legislation was modelled on Vietnam and China, further detail was added to the expanded 2014 law, although most of these are minor changes. For example, some legislative changes grant further concessions to developers, such as the period for income tax exemption being extended from the original five years to eight years. The duration for the lease of land has changed slightly, although the overall maximum length of seventy-five years has not changed. The labour requirements have changed to impose a more stringent labour standard for developers by reducing the time frame for employing local skilled workers to twenty-five per cent citizens in the first two years of operation, fifty per cent in the following two years, and seventy-five per cent in the subsequent two years. Finally, while the amendments in 2014 now include the process for dispute resolution, it simply notes that if disputes cannot be resolved between the parties, they must either be resolved in accordance with the contract, or in accordance with existing laws. The law does not establish a new mechanism for resolving disputes or an avenue for independent review.